

Health & Wellbeing

82 words · Health & Wellbeing

NOUNS

symptom

a sign of illness experienced by the patient

Fever and fatigue are common symptoms of the virus.

appointment

a scheduled time to see a doctor or specialist

She made an appointment with her GP for the following Monday.

diet

the food and drink a person regularly consumes

She changed her diet and started eating more vegetables.

surgery

a medical procedure in which the body is cut open to treat a condition

She needed surgery to repair the torn ligament.

injury

physical damage to part of the body

He suffered a knee injury during training.

mental health

a person's emotional and psychological wellbeing

Mental health is just as important as physical health.

night owl

a person who naturally stays up late and functions better at night

I'm a night owl. I can't seem to get to bed before midnight.

inflammation

redness, swelling, and pain caused by infection or injury

Anti-inflammatory drugs help reduce the inflammation.

treatment

medical care given to a patient for an illness or injury

The treatment involves a course of antibiotics over seven days.

prescription

a written instruction from a doctor authorising medicine for a patient

The doctor gave her a prescription for painkillers.

recovery

the process of returning to health after illness or injury

His recovery from the operation took three months.

allergy

an adverse reaction by the immune system to a substance

She has a severe allergy to penicillin.

stress

mental or emotional strain caused by pressure or worry

Chronic stress can have serious effects on physical health.

check-up

a routine examination by a doctor to assess general health

She goes for an annual check-up every January.

diagnosis

a doctor's identification of an illness based on symptoms and tests

The diagnosis came back as type 2 diabetes.

metabolism

the chemical processes in the body that convert food into energy

A slow metabolism can make it harder to maintain a healthy weight.

immune system

the body's defence mechanism against infection and disease

A poor diet weakens the immune system over time.

anxiety

a persistent feeling of worry, nervousness, or unease

She sought therapy for her anxiety after it began affecting her work.

mindfulness

the practice of being fully aware of and calmly accepting the present moment

Have you tried any mindfulness? It really helped me during a difficult period.

prognosis

a medical prediction of how a disease is likely to develop

The prognosis was positive: a full recovery was expected within three months.

biohacking

the practice of making small, deliberate changes to diet, sleep, or exercise to improve how your body performs

He's deep into biohacking: fasting windows, cold plunges, a ring that tracks every heartbeat.

stigma

a feeling of social disapproval attached to a particular topic or condition

There's still a bit of a stigma around it but I know it helps.

nutrition

the process of consuming the right foods for good health

Good nutrition in childhood is essential for healthy development.

burnout

physical and emotional exhaustion caused by prolonged stress

He was signed off work for a month with burnout.

dry January

a month of not drinking alcohol during January, a popular practice in Britain

Are you doing dry January or is it a longer-term thing?

placebo effect

a measurable improvement caused by belief in treatment rather than the treatment itself

The trial had to account for the placebo effect in its control group.

longevity

the length of time that someone or something lives, especially when this is unusually long

The talk was all about longevity: what the world's oldest people actually eat and do each day.

ADJECTIVES

fit

in good physical condition; healthy and active

He's incredibly fit for his age. He runs every day.

chronic

(of an illness or condition) persisting for a long time

He has a chronic back problem that flares up periodically.

sedentary

characterised by much sitting and little physical activity

A sedentary lifestyle is a major risk factor for heart disease.

healthy

in good physical or mental condition; promoting good health

Eating a balanced diet is the foundation of a healthy lifestyle.

overweight

above the recommended body weight for one's height

The doctor said he was overweight and advised more exercise.

contagious

(of a disease) spreadable from person to person by contact

The virus is highly contagious in enclosed spaces.

run-down

tired and in poor health due to overwork or neglect of self-care

He'd been so run-down that even a minor cold knocked him out.

debilitating

making someone very weak or unable to function normally

The debilitating fatigue made it impossible for her to work.

preventative

designed to stop something harmful from occurring

Preventative healthcare is far more cost-effective than treatment.

bedridden

confined to bed for an extended period due to illness or injury

She was bedridden for two weeks after catching pneumonia.

holistic

treating the whole person (physical, mental, and social) rather than just symptoms

She preferred a more holistic approach to her healthcare.

resilient

able to recover quickly from difficulty, illness, or stress

Children are remarkably resilient, but trauma still leaves lasting marks.

terminal

(of a disease) leading eventually to death; without prospect of recovery

He was given a terminal diagnosis and told to get his affairs in order.

PHRASAL VERBS

get over

to recover fully from an illness

It took her two weeks to get over the chest infection.

pass out

to lose consciousness

She passed out from dehydration during the half-marathon.

cut down on

to reduce the amount of something harmful you consume

She was told to cut down on salt and processed foods.

work out

to do physical exercise, especially at a gym

She works out three times a week to manage her stress levels.

keep up

to maintain a habit, standard, or routine consistently

It's hard to keep up a healthy routine when you're travelling.

come down with

to begin to develop an illness

She came down with flu the day before her holiday.

put off

to delay doing something

I've been meaning to get a check-up but keep putting it off.

fight off

to successfully resist and recover from an illness

He managed to fight off the infection without antibiotics.

burn off

to use up calories or energy through physical activity

He goes for a run to burn off steam after work.

bounce back

to recover quickly and fully from illness or setback

She bounced back from the surgery much faster than expected.

swear by

to have complete confidence in the effectiveness of something

My neighbour swears by cold showers every morning, though the evidence is pretty thin.

wean off

to gradually reduce dependence on a substance or habit

The doctor helped her wean off the medication over three months.

push through

to complete something demanding despite pain or exhaustion

She pushed through the last miles on sheer willpower alone.

COLLOCATIONS

catch a cold

to become infected with a common cold virus

He caught a cold after standing in the rain.

sweet tooth

a strong liking for sweet food

I've cut down on processed food but I still have a sweet tooth.

blue zone

a region where an unusually high number of people live active lives past 100

The programme looked at diet and daily habits in blue zones like Okinawa and Sardinia.

IDIOMS

feel under the weather

to feel slightly unwell

I'm feeling a bit under the weather. I might skip the gym today.

on the mend

recovering and getting better after an illness

She's on the mend, back to work next week, hopefully.

take its toll

to cause gradual damage to someone's health or wellbeing

The years of overwork were beginning to take their toll.

switch off

to stop thinking about work or stress and relax

Work has been relentless and I can't seem to switch off.

soldier on

to continue despite illness, pain, or difficulty

He soldiered on through the cold rather than take a day off.

side effect

an unwanted effect caused by a medicine or medical treatment

Nausea is listed as a possible side effect, so it's best to take it with food.

balanced diet

a diet containing the correct proportions of all essential nutrients

The key to good health is a balanced diet and regular exercise.

clears my head

helps you think more clearly and feel calmer

I go for a run, mostly. It clears my head better than anything else.

be back on your feet

to have recovered from illness and returned to normal activity

She was back on her feet within a week of the operation.

in good shape

in good physical condition; healthy and fit

For someone in their sixties, she's in remarkable shape.

cold turkey

to stop an addictive habit suddenly and completely, without gradually reducing it

She went cold turkey on cigarettes three years ago.

a clean bill of health

a confirmation that someone is in good health after a medical examination

The consultant gave him a clean bill of health after the scan.

at death's door

extremely ill and close to dying

She described how she had been at death's door and miraculously recovered.

fall off the wagon

to return to a bad habit, especially drinking alcohol, after having managed to stop

He'd stayed off cigarettes for a year before falling off the wagon at a stressful work do.

go cold turkey

to stop a habit or addiction suddenly and completely

She gave up cigarettes by going cold turkey, not a single one since January.

in the pink

in excellent health or condition

She's in the pink. You'd never know she had surgery three months ago.

the jury's out

used to say that no decision or conclusion has been reached yet

Maybe, but the jury's out on most of these claims until there's real research.

SET PHRASES

everything in moderation

used to say that it's fine to enjoy something as long as you don't overdo it

She still has cake at parties. It's everything in moderation with her, not strict rules.

coming down with something

beginning to develop an illness

I'm not great, actually. I think I'm coming down with something.

catch things early

to detect a health problem before it becomes serious

Just book it. It's always better to catch things early.

you'd be better off

used to say that a different choice would get a better result

You'd be better off booking me in properly this time.

keep it up

used to encourage someone to continue doing something well, or describe maintaining a habit

I used to go to the gym but I couldn't keep it up.

talking to someone

a gentle way of referring to seeing a therapist or counsellor

Have you thought about talking to someone?

I must insist

used to make a firm but polite request that will not be refused

Actually, I must insist on being seen sooner. The pain's a lot worse today.

MODERN SLANG

knackered

extremely tired or exhausted (British informal)

I'm absolutely knackered after that gym session.

dodgy tummy

an upset stomach (British informal)

I've had a dodgy tummy since that kebab last night.